

RACHEL E. N. HESTER

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SEEKING WORK

Highly responsible graduate student with an excellent academic record seeking position to demonstrate my abilities and learn new skills through challenging and rewarding work. While I get my graduate degree, I am interested in getting experience that will support a future career in a field related to my Biology major. I am organized, self-motivated, friendly, and have a strong work ethic. Core competencies include:

- ArcGIS
- R Coding
- MS Office: Word, Excel, PowerPoint
- Google Suites: Gmail, Google Docs, Sheets, Slides
- Types 75 wpm
- Detail oriented
- Written and verbal communication
- Problem solver
- Adobe Photoshop/Illustrator
- Krita Art Software

EDUCATION

- Current Master's of Science in Biology student at California Polytechnic Pomona
 - 4.00 GPA
 - Thesis: How does temperature affect bite force variables in two species of Alligator Lizard (*Elgaria multicarinata* and *Elgaria coerulea*)
- Bachelor's of Science in Biology with a minor in Studio Arts at California Polytechnic Pomona, graduated 2025
 - 3.97 Total GPA, 4.00 Major GPA
 - Summa Cum Laude and President's Honor List 2021-2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

CPP VIVARIUM, Pomona CA

GRADUATE STUDENT ASSISTANT

2026-PRESENT

- Helped care for reptiles and amphibians and cleaned enclosures and workspaces
- Gave educational talks to elementary school, middle school, and college students

CPP BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES DEPARTMENT, Pomona CA

TEACHING ASSOCIATE

2025-PRESENT

- Taught and graded material for BIO1150L (Basic Biology) Fall 2025
- Taught and graded material for BIO1220 (Foundations of Biology: Evolution, Ecology, and Biodiversity) Spring 2026
- Taught and graded material for BIO2350L (Human Physiology) Fall 2026

CPP BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES DEPARTMENT, Pomona CA

ECOLOGY GRADER

2025

- Graded assignments for BIO3250 (Principles of Ecology) class

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

OC PARKS/OC ZOO, Orange CA

VOLUNTEER

2026-PRESENT

- Animal keeper volunteer at the OC Zoo, helped care for reptiles and children's zoo animals, by cleaning and preparing diets
- Volunteer for the OC Parks

CPP BAT ADVOCACY AND TRACKING SOCIETY CLUB, Pomona CA

TREASURER

2024-2026

- Member of the executive board
- Managed club funds
- Secured funding and planned Bat Box project
- Helped with leading semi-annual Bat Night public outreach events

CPP VIVARIUM, Pomona CA

VOLUNTEER

2024-2026

INTERN

2025

- Helped care for reptiles and amphibians and cleaned enclosures and workspaces
- Gave educational talks to elementary school and college students

DR. LAPPIN'S LAB, DEPARTMENT OF BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES, Pomona CA

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCHER

2024-2025

- Read scientific papers to come up with Master's research focus
- Helped graduate student set up and collect bite force data with chameleons and agamas
- Took cloacal temperature, weight, and head dimension measurements for lizards

DR. BLAKEY'S LAB, DEPARTMENT OF BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES, Pomona CA

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCHER

2024-2025

- Bat feeding buzz identification in Sonobat
- Data entry for ArcGIS bobcat and great gray owl studies

NIKKEI STUDENT UNION CLUB, Pomona CA

SECRETARY/HISTORIAN

2023-2024

- Member of the executive board
- Took board meeting minutes
- In charge of club social media
- Made weekly newsletter

ZOOLOGISTS OF CAL POLY CLUB, Pomona CA

PRESIDENT

2023-2024

FUNDRAISING CHAIR

2021-2022

- Member of the executive board
- Led club executive board and general meetings
- Helped with planning and running club events
- Researched fundraising opportunities

ORANGE PUBLIC LIBRARY, Orange CA

VOLUNTEER

2017-2019

- Sorted and shelved books for lending services
- Planned, organized, and led events for Teen Advisory Group (TAG)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Class C Driver's License
- Red Cross First Aid, CPR, & Oxygen Administration Certification

AWARDS

- Secured \$15,000 TGIF Grant for Bat Advocacy and Tracking Society bat box building and monitoring project
- Steven J. Wickler Memorial Scholarship